

Raw Talent vs TalentNow

Competitive Intelligence Report

Strategic Analysis & South Australia Growth Plan

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Three Things We Need to Know

01

The TalentNow Connect model is architecturally better for WRP

Their \$30/shift marketplace model lets centres employ educators directly — making them WRP-eligible. This is structurally cheaper than any traditional agency and Raw Talent currently has no equivalent offer.

02

Raw Talent's Edge SA win is a time-sensitive supply problem

Edge confirmed us as priority agency. The risk is not competition — it's supply. We don't have enough active, compliant SA educators to fill the volume Edge will generate. This must be fixed now.

03

Raw Talent's human advantage is defensible — but only if we act

Centre visits, personal relationships, and SA-specific compliance knowledge are things TalentNow cannot replicate from NSW. But TalentNow is 8 years ahead in technology. We must close the operational gaps urgently.

Who Is TalentNow?

Founded	2018 by Liddy Korner, Mosman NSW
Reach	National — all states and territories
Self-described	"Uber of childcare" — first app-based ECEC staffing in Australia
Ownership	Independent — not owned by any childcare provider
App	Free iOS + Android — educators sign up in minutes
Contact	1800 840 889 · info@talentnow.com.au

8

Years operating (2018–2026)

2

Distinct products (Connect + Casual Hire)

\$30

Flat booking fee per shift (Connect model)

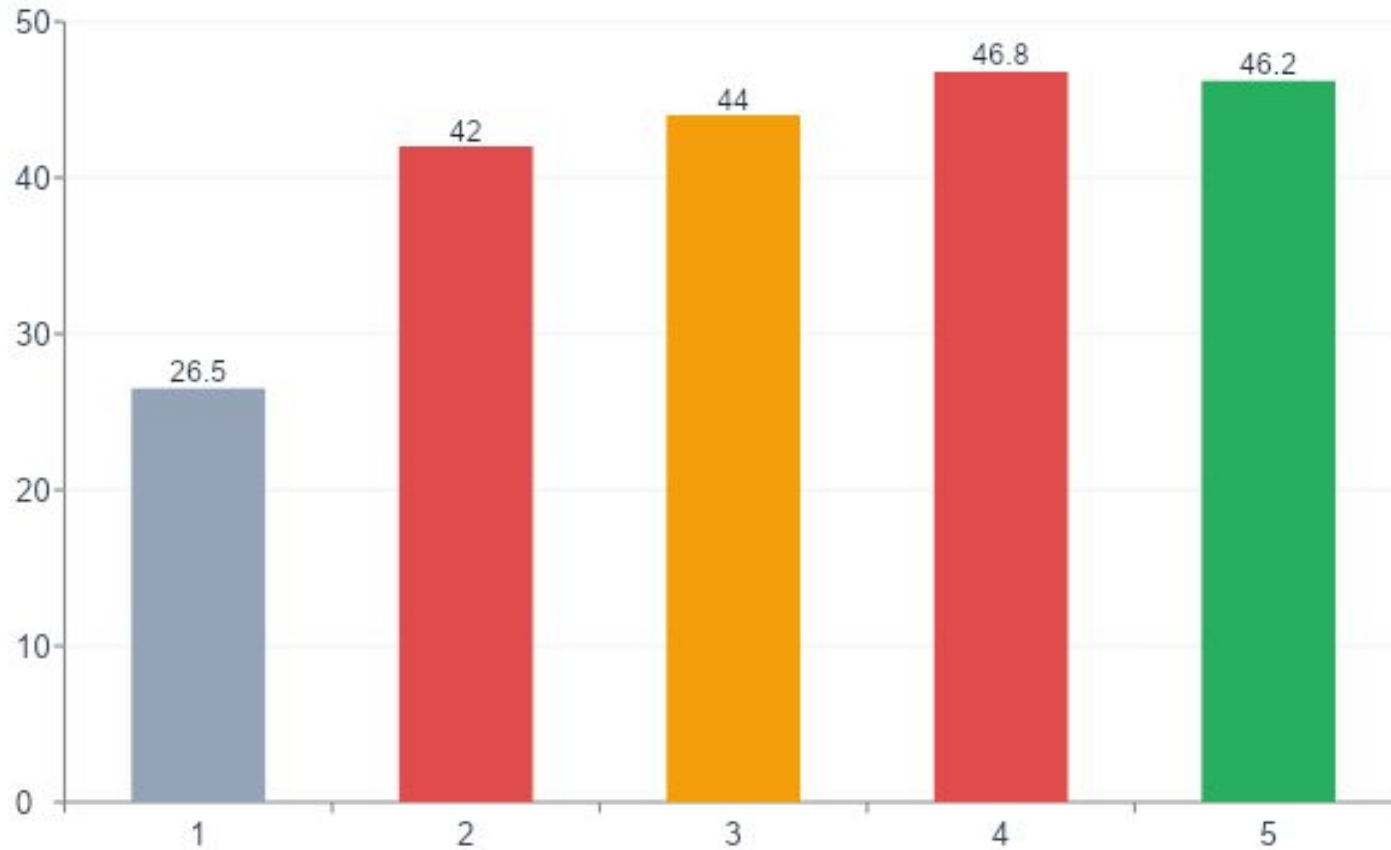
National

Educator pool across all AU states

TalentNow Has Two Models — We Only Have One

	TalentNow CONNECT	TalentNow CASUAL HIRE	Raw Talent (Current)
Who employs educator	Childcare Centre (educator is their casual employee)	TalentNow (agency model)	Raw Talent (agency model)
Cost to centre	\$30 flat fee per shift (any qualification, any duration)	Agency charge rate (educator pay + margin)	Agency charge rate (educator pay + margin)
WRP eligible?	YES — centre accesses government WRP grant directly	Complex — agency must enroll separately	Via WRP toggle for enrolled centres
Payroll managed by	Centre (Employment Hero automates setup)	TalentNow	Raw Talent
Admin for centre	Low — Employment Hero integration handles setup	Very Low — TN handles everything	Very Low — RT handles everything
⚠ Biggest competitive threat			

The SA Pay Gap — Why Educators Are Choosing Competitors



Current Pay Gap

\$4–5/hr

RT vs Entrée in SA

WRP Uplift

+10%

from Dec 2024 (Yr 1)

Gender Uplift (FWC)

9–28%

proposed from Jan 2026

RT with WRP Toggle

~\$46.20

per hour (competitive)

Worker Retention Payment (WRP) — What It Is & Why It Matters

What is the WRP?

The WRP is a Federal Government grant running **2 December 2024 — 30 November 2026**. It funds a **10% wage increase in Year 1** for eligible ECEC workers. The grant goes to approved centres, who must pass it on to their eligible employees. Further increases are legislated for Dec 2026 (+10%), Jul 2028 (+5%), and Jul 2029 (TBD).



Grant flows to centres → centres pass increase to educators

TalentNow CONNECT

Educators employed BY the centre
→ WRP flows directly from
centre's own grant → educators
get full WRP automatically

Raw Talent (Agency Model)

RT employs educator → WRP
toggle available for WRP-enrolled
Edge SA centres

Australian ECEC Regulatory Changes — What Agencies Must Track

URGENT

Late August 2026

National Child Safety Training

Mandatory for ALL ECEC workers, volunteers and students from 27 Feb 2026. Does NOT replace SA state Child Protection training or RAN Training. Approved providers face risk if educators are not compliant.

URGENT

Late March 2026

National Early Childhood Worker Register

Approved providers must enter all workforce information into the new national register. RT must confirm this is in place for all SA educators.

ACTION

30 September 2026

WRP Application Deadline

Final deadline to apply. Backdating to 2 December 2024 required applications by 30 September 2025. WRP payments run until 30 November 2026, with further increases legislated from December 2026.

SA SPECIFIC

Ongoing — check expiry

SA DCSI Screening (SA Only)

South Australia's Working with Children equivalent. NOT the same as VIC WWCC. Educators cannot work across both SA and VIC without BOTH checks. Raw Talent must track separately.

SA SPECIFIC

Ongoing — check renewal

RAN Training (SA Only)

Responding to Abuse and Neglect — SA legislative requirement separate from national NCS Training. Must be verified for every SA educator before deployment.

WAGE REFORM

From January 2026 (est.)

FWC Gender Undervaluation Increase

Fair Work Commission provisional decision: 9–28% uplift for Children's Services Award classifications. Timeline revised from Aug 2025 to Jan 2026. Affects charge rates and educator pay calculations.

Raw Talent vs TalentNow — Head to Head

Feature	TalentNow	Raw Talent	Advantage
Founded / Experience	2018 — 8 years	2016 — 10 years	Raw Talent
Business model	2 models: Connect + Casual Hire	1 model: Agency only	TalentNow
National reach	All states and territories	SA and VIC only	TalentNow
SA market depth	Limited — based in NSW	Strong — Edge partnership	Raw Talent
WRP optimisation	Connect model built around WRP	Toggle available	TalentNow
Flat Booking fee option	\$30/shift (Connect model)	No — agency rate only	TalentNow
Payroll automation	Employment Hero integration	Employment Hero processing	Raw Talent
Compliance tracking	Automated real-time alerts	Manual review process	TalentNow
Personal relationships	Remote, national scale	Liam's centre visits — SA	Raw Talent
Edge SA partnership	No known partnership	CONFIRMED primary agency	Raw Talent
Pay rate competitiveness	~\$44/hr (est. Casual Hire)	~\$42/hr (gap = \$4–5)	TalentNow

Raw Talent — Online Calculator

See what you can save with Talent Now

Step 1

Select qualification level

Certificate III

Step 2

Select shift duration

3h 4h 8h

Step 3

Enter hourly rate charged by agency (for qualification level selected in Step 1)

\$ 40.57 per hour

Cost breakdown

Total charged by agency:

\$162.28

Wages total (incl. super & loading):

\$165.31

Your agency mark-up:

\$-3.03

Save up to
\$-34.03
with Talent Now!

Want the full breakdown?

Email

First Name

Centre Name

Show me the Savings!

Are You Overpaying for Educators?

Find Out How Much You Can Save

Enter the number of agency shifts you book weekly and see how much you could be saving with Raw Talent.

First Name

Enter first name

Last Name

Enter last name

Email

Enter email address

Phone Number:

 Phone Number

Centre Name

Centre Name

No. of shifts

Add no. of shifts

Next

Where TalentNow Beats Raw Talent — Right Now

01 WRP-Native Connect Model

\$30/shift flat fee with centre as employer. Educators get WRP without agency involvement. Unbeatable cost structure for price-sensitive centres.

02 8 Years of Technology

Automated compliance tracking, Employment Hero payroll integration, educator ratings, real-time shift matching. RT is 4–5 years behind on platform maturity.

03 National Educator Pool

Thousands of screened educators across all states. RT's pool is limited to SA and VIC — a vulnerability if Edge expands interstate.

04 Automated Compliance Tracking

TalentNow tracks document expiry dates in real-time and alerts educators automatically. RT does this manually — creating deployment risk.

05 Regulatory Thought Leadership

Dedicated NCS Training 2026 guide, WRP wage change explainer published months ahead. RT has no equivalent. Centres see TalentNow as the compliance authority.

06 Flat Fee Pricing Simplicity

\$30/shift regardless of qualification or duration. Simple, predictable, and cheap. RT's charge rate structure is more complex and less transparent to centres.

Where Raw Talent Has the Edge — SA Specific Advantages

01 Edge SA — Confirmed Primary Agency

TalentNow has no known Edge partnership. This is a captive centre base that gives RT guaranteed shift volume in SA. Protect this at all costs.

02 Personal Centre Relationships

SA centre directors know Liam personally. A national agency based in NSW cannot replicate this trust. These relationships are RT's most defensible asset.

03 SA-Specific Compliance Depth

RT understands DCSI Screening, RAN Training, and SA Child Protection requirements in detail. A national platform like TN may apply generic national compliance.

04 Custom Technology Platform

RT owns its own app (Raj/Prince). While currently limited, ownership means custom features can be built for the specific SA market without SaaS dependencies.

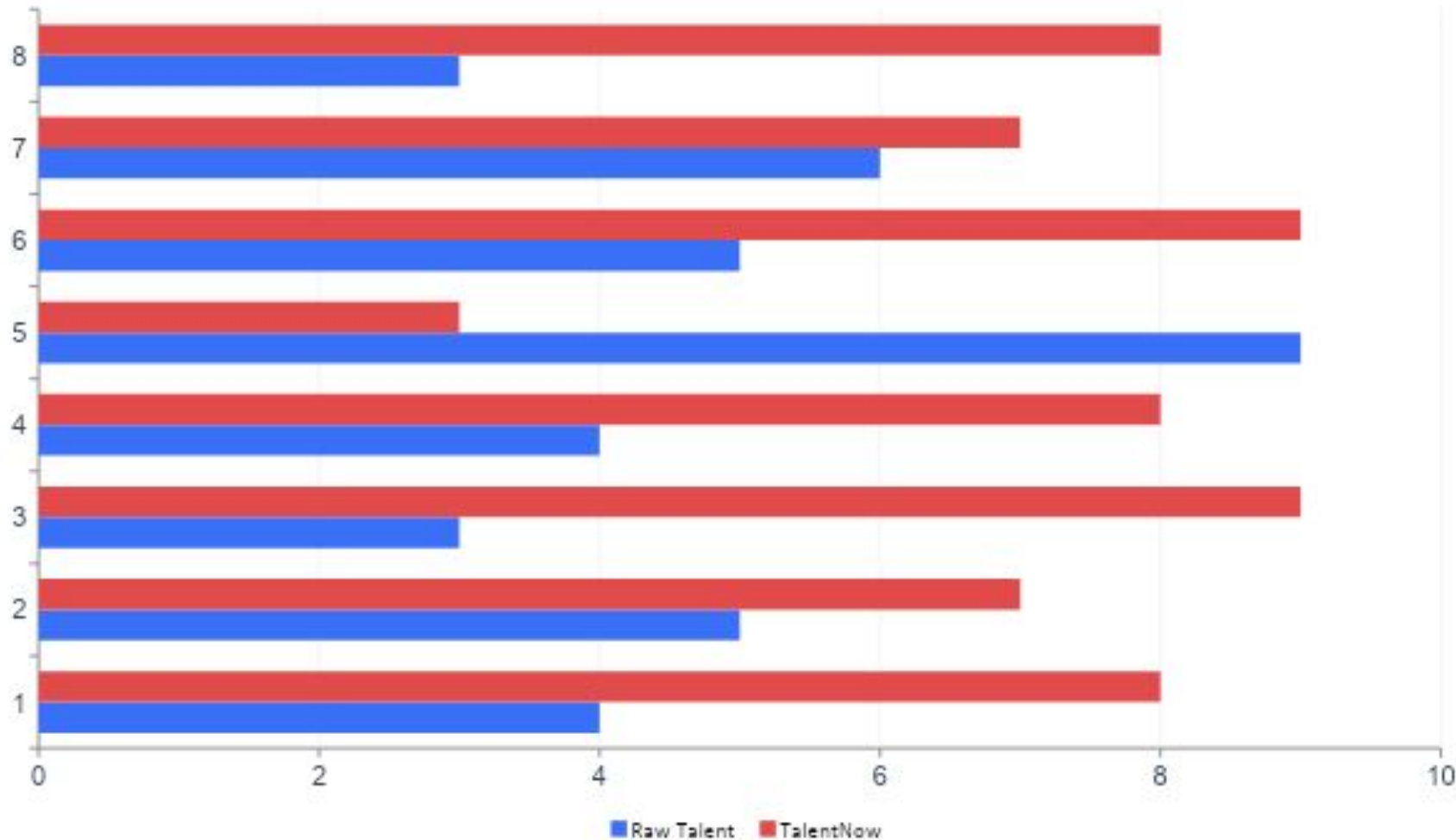
05 Educator Appreciation Program

Liam's personal calls, \$50 gift cards, and named appreciation are human differentiators TalentNow cannot scale. Educators remember how they are treated.

06 Shift Incentive Program (Proposed)

\$50 bonus for 5 completed shifts/week creates financial loyalty. TalentNow does not prominently offer this. Once live, it creates a reason to prefer RT shifts.

The Gaps Raw Talent Must Close — SA Growth Readiness Score



Scoring Methodology

Scores out of 10 represent relative capability based on publicly available data, platform observation, and educator call intelligence. Not financial metrics.

RT Priority Gaps:

1. Compliance tracking automation
2. Onboarding speed & funnel
3. Regulatory communications
4. Tech platform capability
5. WRP toggle activation

SA Growth — Top 10 Priority Actions (June 2026)

1

WEEK 1

Activate WRP Toggle

Build profitability model → get Liam to enable WRP toggle for top 4 low-fill SA centres. Closes pay gap with Entrée immediately.

2

WEEK 1

Prince: Full SA Educator Export

Name, status, last active date, compliance expiry for every SA educator. Segment into A/B/C groups.

3

WEEK 1

NCS Training Audit

Identify every active SA educator who has NOT completed National Child Safety Training. Deadline late August 2026.

4

WEEK 1

Fix Push Notifications

Committed delivery date from Prince: SMS fallback + high-priority channel upgrade. Prerequisite for all supply actions.

5

WEEK 2

Re-engagement Calls Begin

Joy + Sophia call Group A and B SA educators using re-engagement call structure. Capture competitor pay intel.

6

WEEK 2

Facebook Lead Ads — SA

Paid ads targeting Adelaide, 20–45, childcare/TAFE interests. Lead form → JobAdder pipeline.

7

WEEK 2

Activate Referral Program

Confirm \$50 bonus with Liam, manual tracking spreadsheet, brief all consultants to ask for referrals every call.

8

WEEK 2

Cancellation SOP Live

Sophia + Lorie: formal warning on second cancellation, removal on third. Log all cancellations in ClickUp.

9

MONTH 1

TAFE SA Partnership

Liam contacts TAFE SA for access to graduating Cert III cohorts. Pipeline of pre-qualified SA educators.

10

MONTH 1

Onboarding Funnel Restructure

Qualifying filter at registration live. Student pipeline created. Joy + Jane scope all changes in ONE IT build.

Summary & Recommendation

01

Don't try to out-TalentNow TalentNow

Their Connect model and 8-year tech lead are advantages RT cannot close in the short term. Don't compete on price or platform — compete on relationships, compliance depth, and SA-specific intelligence.

02

Win SA with speed, supply, and loyalty

The Edge SA win is a 30–90 day window. Flood SA with active, compliant educators. Close the pay gap via WRP toggle. Lock in educator loyalty with incentives and appreciation. Do all three simultaneously.

03

Build the RT platform as the long-term play

In 3–5 years RT's vision is a marketplace platform. The SA childcare vertical is the proof of concept. Every process, SOP, and tech decision made now should be built as if it will scale to other industries.

Next Steps: WRP toggle model (Joy, Week 1) · SA educator export (Prince, Week 1) · NCS Training audit (Joy + team, Week 1) · Notification fix date (Yuvraj/Prince, Week 1)